Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.
OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.
2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand
3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand
2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠4

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥4

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦J

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♠5

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦A

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A K 9
♥ A J 8 2
♦ A 6
♣ A K 9 3

♠ 10 8 3
♥ K
♦ K 10 8 5 4 3
♣ Q 10 2



♠ 6 5 4
♥ 9 6 4 3
♦ Q J 9
♣ J 7 6

♠ Q J 7 2
♥ Q 10 7 5
♦ 7 2
♣ 8 5 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♣
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♠4

NORTH opens 2♣ and SOUTH responds 2♦ showing fewer than 8 points.

NORTH bids 2NT with a 23 point balanced hand.

SOUTH has enough points to bid 3NT, but with two 4-card Major suits bids 3♣ Stayman instead. NORTH won't confuse this as the second negative since that bid isn't used after a 2NT rebid.

So NORTH shows her 4-card ♥ suit and SOUTH bids 4♥.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 5 4 2
♥ J 10 9 7 6
♦ 2
♣ 10 8 5 2

♠ A K 9
♥ A K 2
♦ A 8 3
♣ A Q 7 4



♠ Q 6 3
♥ Q 8 5
♦ K 7 6 4
♣ K J 3

♠ J 10 8 7
♥ 4 3
♦ Q J 10 9 5
♣ 9 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♣	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT	Pass	6NT	
All Pass			

6NT by East
Lead: ♥4

EAST has a balanced hand with 11 points, so she responds 2NT to WEST's 2♣ opening bid.

WEST bids 3NT. This shows 22-24 points, a hand he was planning to rebid 2NT.

EAST knows the side has at least 33 points, but no more than 35 so she bids 6NT.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ 7 2 ♥ 9 7 5 3 ♦ Q 7 4 2 ♣ Q 9 3	
♠ J 9 5 ♥ J 4 ♦ J 10 8 5 3 ♣ J 10 4		♠ 10 4 3 ♥ Q 6 ♦ K 9 6 ♣ A K 7 5 2
	♠ A K Q 8 6 ♥ A K 10 8 2 ♦ A ♣ 8 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♦J

SOUTH has both Majors and enough points to open 2♣. NORTH, with 4 points, responds with a negative 2♦.

SOUTH first bids her higher ranking suit, 2♠. NORTH is too strong for second negative, he bids 2NT.

SOUTH now shows her second suit, 3♥.

NORTH is happy to bid the game in ♥s.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 10 5 4 ♥ 10 3 ♦ 10 9 2 ♣ A 9 8 7 5	
♠ A Q 2 ♥ A K Q 5 ♦ K 7 5 ♣ K Q 10		♠ K 7 3 ♥ 9 8 2 ♦ A Q J 8 6 ♣ J 2
	♠ J 9 8 6 ♥ J 7 6 4 ♦ 4 3 ♣ 6 4 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♣	Pass	3♦	Pass
3NT	Pass	6NT	
All Pass			

6NT by West
Lead: ♠5

WEST has a balanced hand with 23 points. He opens 2♣ and expects to rebid 2NT.

EAST has 12 points so makes a positive response in her best suit. Since that suit is ♦s she must jump to the 3-level.

WEST now describes his balanced, minimum hand by bidding 3NT.

EAST bids 6NT, knowing that the partnership holds at least 34 points.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ K 6 ♥ A K Q J 2 ♦ K Q J ♣ K Q J	
♠ Q J 8 5 ♥ 10 8 6 ♦ 10 7 ♣ 10 8 5 4		♠ 4 3 ♥ 4 3 ♦ A 9 6 4 3 ♣ 9 7 6 2
	♠ A 10 9 7 2 ♥ 9 7 5 ♦ 8 5 2 ♣ A 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by North
Lead: ♦A

SOUTH, with 9 points and a 5-card suit, should make a positive response, 2♠.

NORTH bids her ♥s and SOUTH agrees the trump suit with a 4♥ bid.

NORTH thinks there is a slam, so she invokes Blackwood. Hearing that SOUTH holds two Aces she bids 6NT. She could also have bid 6♥ but 6NT scores a little more.